Eternal Rivals S1 Tournament Rules

Mobile Legends: Bang Bang

Introduction

This document outlines the official rules and guidelines for the "Eternal Rivals S1" Mobile Legends: Bang Bang (MLBB) tournament, detailing the two-stage structure and the unique point system for the Group Stage.

1. Stage 1: Group Stage (Round Robin)

1.1 Tournament Structure & Progression

Detail	Description
Total Teams	24 Teams
Groups	6 Groups (A, B, C, D, E, F)
Teams Per Group	4 Teams
Stage 1 Format	Round Robin (Each team plays every other team in their group once)
Advancement	The **top 2** teams from each of the 6 groups (12 teams total) advance directly to Stage 2.
Group Match Format	All Group Stage matches are **Best-of-Three (BO3)**

1.2 Group Stage Point System (Mandatory)

Points are awarded based on the result of each Best-of-Three (BO3) match:

- A team that wins 2-0 receives **2 points** plus a **+1 bonus point**, for a total of **3 points**. The losing team receives 0 points.
- A team that wins 2-1 receives **2 points**. The losing team receives **1 point**.
- A team that wins by walkover receives **2 points**. The opposing team receives 0 points.

- At the end of the Group Stage, teams are ranked based on their total accumulated points.

Match Results	Winning Team Points	Losing Team Points
2-0 Win	3 Points (2 + 1 Bonus)	0 Points
2-1 Win	2 Points	1 Point
Walkover Win	2 Points	0 Points

1.3 Wildcard Round (3rd-Place Teams)

The 3rd-place finisher from each of the 6 groups (6 teams total) is not eliminated and instead competes in a Wildcard Round for a chance to reach Stage 2. These 6 teams are split into two Wildcard Groups:

- **Wildcard Group G:** 3rd-place teams from Groups A, B, and C (3 teams).
- **Wildcard Group H:** 3rd-place teams from Groups D, E, and F (3 teams).

Each Wildcard Group plays a single Round Robin, with every match played as a **Best-of-One (BO1)**. The **top 2** teams from each Wildcard Group (4 teams total) advance to Stage 2, joining the 12 teams that qualified directly from the Group Stage.

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1.4 Tie-Breaker Rule

If two or more teams are tied on points for an advancement spot — whether within a Group or within a Wildcard Group — a single **Best-of-One (BO1)** match will be conducted immediately following the conclusion of the relevant stage to determine the advancing team.

2. Stage 2: Knockout

2.1 Stage 2 Overview

A total of **16 teams** advance to Stage 2: the 12 direct qualifiers (top 2 teams from each of Groups A–F) plus the 4 Wildcard qualifiers (top 2 teams from Wildcard Groups G and H). These 16 teams compete in a single-elimination knockout bracket, beginning with a Round of 16.

2.2 Round of 16 Matchups

Match	Fixture
1	A1 vs B2
2	A2 vs B1

3	C1 vs D2
4	D1 vs C2
5	E1 vs G1
6	E2 vs G2
7	F1 vs H1
8	F2 vs H2

2.3 Match Progression

The format length will increase as the tournament progresses:

- **Round of 16 & Quarter-Finals:** Best-of-Three (BO3)
- **Semi-Final Rounds:** Best-of-Three (BO3)
- **Grand Finals:** Best-of-Five (BO5)

3. General Rules

3.1 Team Composition & Eligibility

- **Roster Size**: Each team must consist of five (5) primary players and a maximum of two (2) substitute players, totaling a maximum roster size of seven (7).
- **Eligibility**: All participants must be Sri Lankan citizens residing in Sri Lanka. Proof of citizenship and residency may be requested.
- **Substitutions**: Substitutes may only be used between games in a series (Ex. between Game 1 and Game 2) and must be registered on the official roster. Once a player is substituted out, they may re-enter the series in a later game.

3.2 Scheduling and Walkovers

- **Readiness:** Teams must be present and ready to enter the draft lobby at the scheduled match time.
- **Grace Period:** A maximum 10-minute grace period will be provided from the notified match time.
- **Walkover Declaration:** If a team is not ready and present in the draft lobby after the 10-minute grace period, Victory will be given to the opposing team by Walkover, awarding them the specified 2 Points (as defined in Section 1.2).

- **Rescheduling:** Postponement or rescheduling is permitted only if both participating teams agree and the tournament organizers are notified at least 2 days prior to the original date with a justifiable reason.

3.3 Drafting Phase & Redrafts

- **Drafting Process:** Standard MLBB tournament drafting rules (ban/pick process) will apply.
- **Redraft Request (Draft Disconnect):** If a player disconnects during the drafting phase, the team leader must report the issue immediately.

a. Each team is allowed to request a redraft only once per series.

b. In a redraft, the previous bans from both teams must be followed, except for the ban made by the disconnected player (if applicable).

- **Draft Restrictions:** Any specific hero or item restrictions will be communicated before the tournament begins.

3.4 Conduct & Communication Discipline

I. **Sportsmanship:** High standards of sportsmanship and professional conduct are mandatory. Respect must be shown toward all opponents, referees, and organizers.

II. **Pre-Match Lobby Conduct:** Toxic, offensive, or unsportsmanlike behavior in the pre-match lobby is strictly forbidden. Only the Team Captain is permitted to use the in-game lobby chat for neutral setup purposes.

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III. **In-Game Chat Restriction & Pause Exception:** ALL forms of text messaging in "All Chat" are strictly prohibited, with one sole exception:

a. **Immediate Pause Request:** If a team requires an emergency technical pause, the Team Captain must immediately type the letter 'P' in All Chat to notify all players to stop active playing and remain neutral. Any other text, including explanations, is forbidden.

b. Recalls and emotes are permitted unless deemed excessive or intentionally disruptive by a referee.

IV. **Official WhatsApp Group Discipline:** Official match WhatsApp groups are designated solely for match coordination, technical issues, and formal pause requests. Professional, brief, and respectful communication in this channel is mandatory.

3.5 Competitive Integrity & Identity Verification (Top 08 Stage)

To ensure fair competition and address complaints regarding account sharing (ringing) and unauthorized software, all players are subject to device and identity checks, particularly from the Top 08 stage onwards.

I. **Inspection Triggers:** Tournament officials reserve the right to initiate a device inspection or player identity verification at any time, including before, during (upon a pause), or immediately after a match.

a **Triggers:** Inspections will be initiated either randomly or specifically due to a formal complaint regarding cheating or suspected Account Sharing (Ringer).

II. **Scope of Inspection:** The scope is strictly limited to verifying player identity and identifying an unfair competitive advantage. This includes:

a **Player Identity Verification:** Confirmation that the player competing is the registered player for that account. Officials may demand immediate physical identity checks (Ex. Hand-Cam or Government ID verification). Supplementary evidence may include verified account statistics (such as historical peak rank, win rate, or hero KDA) and past tournament performance (such as documented results in previous official events).

b **Unauthorized Software:** Detection of third-party applications, scripts, or modified game files ("hacks") that manipulate game mechanics.

c **Prohibited Peripherals:** External tools or accessories (hardware/software) that are not officially approved by the organizers.

III. **Approved Device:** Players must use the same gaming device for all matches within the Top 08 stage unless a replacement is approved by the tournament organizers due to a technical failure.

IV. **Player Cooperation:** Players must fully cooperate with all inspection and identity verification requests from tournament officials. Failure to cooperate will result in immediate penalties.

3.6 Game Rules & Technical Requirements

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- **Standard Rules:** Standard MLBB game objectives, map layout, and victory conditions apply.
- **Hardware:** Players must use mobile devices for gameplay.
- **Integrity Check (Hand-Cams):** ALL PLAYERS MUST BE READY TO OPEN HAND-CAMS immediately upon request by a referee or organizer (refer to Rule 9.2).
- **Technical Issues (In-Game Pause):**

- A pause for a **full game restart with the same draft** must be requested within **30 seconds** of the game starting.
- Each team is allowed up to **two (02) technical pauses** per game for connection difficulties, each lasting a maximum of **3 minutes**.
- **Pause Procedure (MANDATORY):** To request a pause:
- The Team Captain must immediately type 'P' into All Chat (per Rule 8.3) to inform all players to stop active playing and remain neutral.
- The Team Captain must simultaneously send the letter 'P' into the designated WhatsApp Match Group chat to formally notify the referee.

- The referee will administer the pause as soon as possible. Play must not resume until the referee unpauses the game.

3.7 Dispute Resolution & Penalties

I. **Dispute Procedures:** In the event of a dispute or complaint, teams must immediately contact tournament officials (referees or administrators).

II. **Penalties:** Cheating, account sharing (ringing), harassment, unsportsmanlike behavior, or repeated violation of these rules will result in penalties ranging from a game loss to disqualification from the tournament.

III. **Malicious Complaints:** Any player or team found to have filed a false, malicious, or bad-intentioned complaint against an honest player for the purpose of disruption or gaining an unfair advantage will be subject to severe disciplinary action, including a formal warning or outright team disqualification, at the organizers' final discretion.

IV. **Discretionary Authority:** The organizers' decisions on all rulings, technical issues, and disputes are final and binding. Furthermore, notwithstanding any other provision in this Rulebook, Tournament Organizers reserve the right to modify, supersede, or enforce penalties beyond those explicitly outlined if, in their sole and absolute discretion, it is deemed necessary to preserve the competitive integrity or fairness of the tournament.

4. Conclusion

By adhering to this updated rule set, we ensure a fair and consistent "Eternal Rivals S1" tournament. These new integrity checks and policies are designed to protect both the honest competitors and the fairness of the competition.

The decisions made by the organizers are final. All participants are expected to respect and comply with their rulings at all time